Privacy Notice on the Protection of Personal Data for Membership Applications and Association Membership

Version 1.2 | 27 October 2026

1. Data Controller

Pursuant to the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR / DSGVO), the data controller is:
METU Alumni Deutschland i. Gr.
Berliner Allee 59, 40212 Düsseldorf
E-mail: info@odtum.de

2. Collection and Processing of Personal Data

In connection with your membership application and your membership, we collect and process the following personal data:

- Basic Information: Surname, first name, date of birth
- Contact Information: Home address (street, house number, postal code, city) and email address
- Academic Credentials and Residency Status (ordinary membership only): Proof of your METU (ODTÜ) degree, such as a copy of the diploma or the Diploma Supplement, your declaration of residence in Germany and, optionally, your department and year of graduation for each METU degree
- Optional Information: Company or organisation, and position or role
- Membership Fee Discount Status: Whether the applicant is a student or not. Students who apply for the reduced rate provide a certificate of enrolment (Immatrikulationsbescheinigung) for each contribution year; for the year of admission, with the application.
- Payment Data (for the SEPA Direct Debit Mandate, SEPA-Lastschriftmandat): Account holder's name and address, IBAN and, where required, BIC, the member's name if the account holder is another person, the mandate reference (Mandatsreferenz) and the date of the mandate
- Payment Records: For each payment received, the payer's name and IBAN, the amount, the date and the payment reference as shown in the association's bank statements, including any designation of an amount as a donation (Spende)
- Hardship Applications: The reasons and any evidence you provide with an application for a reduction, waiver or deferral of contributions

Where the account holder or the payer is a person other than the member, this notice also applies to that person.

Providing your data is voluntary. However, all data not marked as optional is required to admit you and to administer your membership; without it, we cannot process your application. Payment data are required only if you choose to pay by direct debit; otherwise you pay by bank transfer. A certificate of enrolment is required only for the reduced rate; without it, the full contribution applies. Data on hardship are needed only if you apply for relief.

Where the Board examines a report under the Code of Conduct (Verhaltenskodex), or a possible ground for refusing admission or for expulsion under the bylaws, we also process data that we do not collect from you: the content of reports by members or other persons, and information from publicly accessible sources, such as the federal report on the protection of the constitution (Verfassungsschutzbericht des Bundes) and your public statements or offices. These data may reveal political opinions.

3. Purposes and Legal Bases for Processing

Your data will be processed solely for the following purposes:

- Establishment and Administration of Membership: For the proper maintenance of the membership register, communication with you, and the fulfillment of our duties under the association's statutes (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – performance of the membership contract).
- Verification of Membership Requirements: The supporting documents provided (e.g., copy of diploma) are processed to verify whether you meet the membership requirements specified in the association's statutes (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – steps taken at your request before membership).
- Compliance with Legal Obligations: To comply with statutory retention obligations under tax and

association law (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(c) GDPR).
- Determination of Membership Fee: The information provided regarding student status and the certificate of enrolment are processed to determine eligibility for the reduced rate (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – performance of the membership contract).
- Collection of Membership Fees: For collecting and recording contributions paid by bank transfer or SEPA Direct Debit, including pre-notifications, reminders and refunds of overpayments (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR).
- Hardship Applications: For deciding applications for a reduction, waiver or deferral of contributions; the application and any evidence are seen only by the Board and the auditors (Kassenprüfer) (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR).
- Donations: For recording donations you designate and, where the association is entitled to do so, issuing donation receipts (Zuwendungsbestätigungen) (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR).
- Code of Conduct Proceedings: For examining reports and conducting proceedings under the Code of Conduct (Verhaltenskodex) and the bylaws, including warnings, suspensions, expulsions and refusals of admission (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR; where data revealing political opinions or other special categories of personal data are concerned, Article 9(2)(f) GDPR and, for data you have manifestly made public, Article 9(2)(e) GDPR).

4. Disclosure of Data to Third Parties

We disclose your personal data only to:
- service providers that process it for us under a data processing agreement (Article 28 GDPR), in particular our membership software (easyVerein) and our email provider;
- our bank, to collect membership fees;
- in the case of a proposed expulsion, or of your appeal against a suspension or a refused application: the members at the General Assembly that decides on it. They receive only the facts needed for the decision;
- public authorities or other persons, where the law requires us to disclose it.

5. Retention Period and Deletion of Data

- Member Data: Your general personal data will be retained for the duration of your membership. After your membership ends, your data will be deleted unless they are still needed to settle outstanding contributions or to establish, exercise or defend legal claims, or a legal obligation requires their retention (for example, ten years for books and records and eight years for accounting vouchers such as bank statements, under Section 147 of the German Fiscal Code (AO)).
- Refused Applications: If your application is refused, your data will be deleted once the one-month period for applying for a decision of the General Assembly has expired or, if you so apply, once the General Assembly has decided. This also applies if the refusal is based on a reason for which a member could be expelled. Any reports and other information used for the decision are deleted at the same time, unless they are needed to defend legal claims.
- Academic Documents (Diplomas/Supporting Documents): Copies of submitted diplomas will be permanently deleted after verification and membership approval. Only confirmation of successful verification will be retained.
- Student Certificates: Any student certificate submitted for the purpose of obtaining a membership fee discount will be deleted after verification, unless a legal retention obligation applies.
- SEPA Direct Debit Mandates: A mandate is kept while it is in use and for 14 months after the last debit made under it was submitted.
- Hardship Applications: The application and any evidence will be deleted once the Board has decided; the decision is kept with the record of your contributions.
- Code of Conduct Proceedings: Records of proceedings will be deleted at the end of the third calendar year after the proceedings ended. Where the Board takes no measure, they will be deleted once it has decided not to pursue the matter.

6. Your Rights

Under the GDPR, you have the right to obtain information about the personal data stored about you (Article 15), the right to rectification (Article 16), the right to erasure (Article 17), the right to restriction of processing (Article 18), the right to data portability (Article 20), and the right to object (Article 21). You also have the right to lodge a complaint with a competent data protection supervisory authority.